The fluids contain in solution all the materials for the formation of solids, and as the fluids and solids are mutually convertible, and constantly interchanging states, their constituent elements do not differ materially from each other.

The following elements are found in more or less variable proportions in the human system: oxygen, hydrogen, nitrogen, carbon, sulphur, phosphorus, silicon, chlorine, fluorine, and iron. There are other elements occasionally found in the body, such as manganesium, aluminum, and copper, but these are rather incidental than constant in their presence.

There are, without reckoning the teeth, about two hundred and eight pieces of bone, arranged for the most part in pairs, and grouped symmetrically on either side of the body. The bony structure may be divided into the cranium inclosing the brain; the bones of the face; the trunk, including the sternum, vertebræ, twelve pairs of ribs, the collar-bones and shoulder-blades; and the pelvis, which supports the abdominal regions. The lower extremities consist of the thigh and knee-bones, the legs, feet, and toes. The upper extremities include the arms, hands, and fingers.

The cranium incloses the brain and its appropriate system of blood-vessels, and also bounds the face, organs of special sense, and cranial nerves. The thorax and vertebræ inclose the heart, lungs, blood-vessels, and spinal cord. The pelvic basin supports the stomach, liver, pancreas, spleen, bladder, intestines, and organs of generation. Thus the bony structure performs the important office of protecting,